maintains confidential records. Secretary has a reference even in the Ancient Indian History during the Mughal and Maratha Empire. They were known as 'Amatya' , 'Sachiva', or 'Chitnis'. The profession of a secretary is considered as one of the oldest professions. It is known to be as old as the human civilizations.

The secretary has been defined as "A person who assists the management in achieving the objectives of the organization. He is entrusted with secrets and confidential matters of his master/ employer. He records all the relevant informations for future reference and vital decision making purposes. The secretary is entrusted with work such as administering the office, and related office work, conducting periodical meetings, co-ordinating departmental work, to have cordial relationship with public in connection with related official work, to develop company image in the society, to write suitable correspondence to various offices/authorities etc.,".



In Rome the scribae worked out of the aerarium, the state treasury and government archieve. They received a good salary, but could earn additional commissions for collecting and recording state revenues, and making official copies of government documents and decrees. The roman posting was such a lucrative assignment that the scribae worked in rotations, serving one year in Rome and two in the provinces.

The secretary is an important officer of the company who is appointed to perform the ministerial or administrative duties. In modern times, the secretary has become almost an obliged person in trade, industry and other social institutions. Every organisation thinks it is necessary to appoint a secretary for conducting its affairs properly. The reason for the same is that the secretary helps in conducting all correspondence, keeping all records and accounts, writing of minutes and acts as public relation officer of the employer between the management, staff and the outsiders. The importance of a secretary is specially felt in the business world since the business organisations have to abide by certain legal requirements. Moreover, the secretary ensures that the affairs of the organisation are conducted in accordance with law.

10.2 Meaning of Office Secretary or Personal Secretary

A person who is employed to take care of records, letters and routine work for an another person. An officer of a business corporation or society who is in charge of the letters and records and who keeps minutes of meetings. A secretary has been defined otherwise, as a person who is employed to do office work, such as typing letters, answering phone calls and arranging meetings. The secretary of a company is the person who has the legal duty of keeping the company's records.

An Office Secretary maintains the smooth running of an office through a variety of administrative and clerical duties. They handle office schedules, coordinate meetings and visits, organize files, answer phones and perform a huge array of other essential tasks. Office Secretaries generally work directly for organization and depending on their experience they may also supervise other clerical staffs. Office Secretaries are employed virtually in every industry, particularly business, law, medicine and education. Job growth for Office Secretaries is slow but steady.

XII OSS_English version CHAPTER 10.indd 128 1/7/2020 6:12:03 PM